

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Frequently Asked Questions

Consolidated answers for customers, IT administrators, and analysts

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How This Document Fits

This is a **Reference** guide. It consolidates frequently asked questions across the current Copilot Analytics capability areas. For setup, see the Admin Setup Guide. For issue resolution, see the Troubleshooting Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference (you are here)	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

Licensing & Access

Q1. Can managers see individual employee Copilot usage?

Not by default. Dashboard metrics are aggregated at group level and protected by minimum group size thresholds (default 10, minimum 5), differential privacy, and distribution masking. The exception is **Identification**:

Copilot Analytics outputs are de-identified by default, but Identification lets authorised users see named employees (“identified outputs”). It is governed by its own Viva Feature Access Management (VFAM) policy, which only a Microsoft 365 Global Administrator or an AI Administrator can create. Check which identification and identifiable-export policies are on before answering this question for a tenant; see the Identification question under Privacy below.

Q2. What happens if we drop below 50 licences?

Core Dashboard capabilities remain available with 1+ Copilot licences. For 50-plan capabilities, Environment requirements for Viva Insights (Last updated 12 May 2026) counts the Viva Insights service plan included with Copilot and explicitly says **30 Copilot + 20 Viva Insights qualifies as 50 service plans**. The Dashboard article (Last updated 18 August 2026) separately says 50 Copilot or 50 Viva Insights. Do not assume mixed licensing fails: verify assigned service plans and tenant feature presence. For Agent Dashboard preview, conservatively require 50 Copilot licences plus agent activity.

Q3. Can we trial the Dashboard before licensing everyone?

Yes. With 1 assigned Copilot licence, eligible tenants can begin using core Readiness, Adoption, and Impact capabilities. For 50-plan capabilities, count assigned Viva Insights service plans and validate the mixed-licence source conflict described above. Agent Dashboard is preview and should conservatively be treated as requiring 50 Copilot licences plus agent activity.

Q4. How is Copilot Chat usage reported?

The Dashboard uses the current merged **Copilot Chat** metric; retain **Copilot Chat (legacy web)** only as a legacy transition series that is expected to trend toward zero. For users without a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, the Microsoft 365 admin center provides a dedicated, exportable Microsoft Copilot Chat usage report (Last updated 18 August 2026). The Dashboard licence view, admin report, licensed-user-only Graph endpoint, and Purview audit are separate reporting surfaces.

Q5. How often does the data refresh?

The Copilot Dashboard refreshes **daily**, showing a 28-day rolling window with up to a 6-day delay from the current date. Admin center usage reports typically become available within **24 to 72 hours** (the Copilot Chat usage report states within 48 hours of the end of the day, UTC), and can take several days. Newly licensed employees may take an additional 7 days before appearing.

Q6. Is a separate Viva Insights licence needed if we already have Microsoft 365 Copilot?

No. Every M365 Copilot licence automatically includes the Viva Insights service plan — covering personal insights, manager/leader insights, and advanced analysis. A separate Viva Insights purchase is only needed if you want to analyse employees who do *not* have Copilot licences.

Q7. Who needs licences — only leaders viewing dashboards, or also the employees whose data we want to analyse?

The employees you analyse need licences; for people who only view dashboards, Microsoft's sources differ.

Employees whose collaboration data you want to analyse must have a Viva Insights licence assigned (included with every Copilot licence). Microsoft's Dashboard article states that neither a paid Viva Insights licence nor a Microsoft Copilot licence is required to view the Dashboard, although its FAQ describes organisational-attribute filtering for leaders who have a Viva Insights licence; the two statements are not reconciled on the page. Viewing depends on an access source, not on the viewer's licence (see Scenario 02); verify in the tenant.

Organizational Data

Q8. Can we see data by business unit, department, or country?

Yes, but you must upload organizational data (a CSV file with attributes like Business Unit, Department, Country) to enable these filters. Without an org data upload, only the Entra ID "Department" field is available as a filter.

Q9. Do I need to manually prepare and upload a CSV if we use SAP SuccessFactors or Workday?

No. Microsoft provides native HRIS connectors for both SAP SuccessFactors and Workday (Workday limited to ≤100K users). These connectors pull employee data directly from your HRIS on a weekly or monthly schedule.

Q10. Can I automate monthly CSV uploads?

Yes — multiple options exist: (1) **HRIS connectors** (SAP SuccessFactors, Workday) auto-sync on a schedule. (2) **Azure Blob Storage connector** — drop a CSV into an Azure blob and it's picked up automatically. (3) **API-based import** (preview) — push data via REST API. Microsoft provides sample code at github.com/microsoft/orgdata_apibasedimport.

Q11. We have Department in Entra — why do we still need to upload org data?

Entra ID only syncs **3 attributes** to Viva Insights: PersonId (UPN), ManagerId, and Organization (from the Department field). Extension attributes (`extensionAttribute1-15`), Company, Division, JobTitle, City, and Country are **not synced** — even if populated in Entra via AD Connect. To use these attributes in Viva Insights, upload them via CSV or configure an HRIS connector.

Q12. We uploaded org data and now filters show different values — can we revert?

Yes, by attribute and surface. Use **parallel data ingestion** to restore Entra as the source for `ManagerId` and `Organization` while retaining uploaded custom attributes. To remove uploaded values, first confirm Entra is configured for those two fields, then use the documented Organizational Data update/delete operations for optional fields. Do **not** seed dummy rows. Microsoft 365 Profile precedence is a separate setting. See Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads (updated 7 July 2026) and Import and manage your organizational data with a .csv file — Update or delete data (updated 27 August 2026). Test the change, record success/failure criteria, and escalate migration rollback failures through Microsoft Support.

Q13. “View by: Group” shows only one person’s name instead of sub-groups. How do I fix this?

The Group view uses the uploaded manager hierarchy. If most employees report directly to the top-level leader (flat hierarchy), the dashboard cannot split into sub-groups. **Fix:** Ensure intermediate managers (VPs, Directors) exist as rows in your data file with correct manager chains. Every manager value (`ManagerId` , or `Microsoft_ManagerEmail` in the Microsoft 365 admin center path) must match a person value (`PersonId` , or `Microsoft_PersonEmail`) in the same file.

Privacy

Q14. Can employees opt out of being analysed?

Users can opt out of Viva Insights **personal insights** via their settings. For aggregated insights, an AI Administrator can create a **unified exclusion list** that hides specific users in the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard and Viva Insights collaboration reports.

Q15. Does Power BI bypass the minimum group size?

No. Power BI template reports from Viva Insights enforce the same minimum group size threshold as the Dashboard. The privacy control is applied at the data aggregation layer, not the UI layer.

Q16. How is the \$72/hour default for Copilot Assisted Value calculated?

The \$72/hour is based on data compiled by the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics as a broad estimate of loaded labour cost. **Customers should adjust this to their own loaded rate** for accurate ROI calculations. The rate can be changed in the Impact settings or via the Hours and Value calculator on the dashboard. Note: this rate is session-only and not persistent per current guidance.

Q17. What is Identification in Copilot Analytics, and who controls it?

Copilot Analytics outputs are de-identified **by default**. **Identification** lets authorised users see named employees (“identified outputs”) when added precision is needed and permitted. Microsoft lists it for Consumption Dashboard insights and data export, and lists Copilot Dashboard and Agent Dashboard data exports as private preview. For the Agent Dashboard export, Microsoft’s articles disagree: Identification says private preview, while Export data from the Agent Dashboard says identifiable export “is for public preview customers only”; validate in the tenant. Access is governed by a dedicated Viva Feature Access Management (VFAM) policy, which only a Microsoft 365 Global Administrator or an AI Administrator can create (up to 20 users or groups per policy and 10 policies per feature; one tenant-wide policy per feature). When identifiable export is enabled for a user, their export includes identifiable fields; otherwise personal identifiers are replaced with anonymised IDs. Treat identified outputs as a higher privacy classification than aggregated Dashboard metrics. Source: Identification in Copilot Analytics.

General

Q18. Can we use the Agent Dashboard without the Copilot Dashboard?

Treat Agent Dashboard as a separate entitlement and access check within the Viva Insights web app; the Copilot Agent view is in **public preview**. The feature-specific article requires 50 Microsoft Copilot licences plus agent activity, while the broader Dashboard article also lists a 50-Viva-Insights path. Use the Copilot threshold conservatively and validate a Viva-only tenant. Manager access is not settled by Microsoft’s sources: the Agent Dashboard article says enabled managers can see agent insights scoped to their teams, while the Roles in Viva Insights matrix lists no Manager access to it, so verify it in the tenant before relying on either reading. Delegates need “Your company” or “Combined access”, not “Your group”. It is not available in GCC-M or GCC-H, or in other national or regional clouds. Source: Connect to the Agent Dashboard (Last updated 2 September 2026) and Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (Last updated 30 September 2026).

Q19. We want broader productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time, after-hours). Is that covered here?

No — that is a separate Viva Insights workstream. Copilot Analytics covers Copilot-specific adoption, impact, and ROI. Broader productivity metrics use the same Viva Insights licence and analyst role but are configured through different queries and templates. Behavioral insights (meetings, focus, after-hours) are off by default for new customers and must be switched on through the Viva Feature Access Management “Behavioral insights” control by an AI Administrator or Viva Insights admin; allow five days for processing. See the Collaboration Analysis Guide for details.

Q20. What are intent patterns, and how do they appear in the Dashboard?

Intent patterns categorise supported Copilot Chat prompts into four groups: **Ask and find**, **Catch up**, **Draft and brainstorm**, and **Other**. These appear on the Adoption page and help explain how people use Copilot, not just how much. Validate preview status and tenant availability before depending on them.

Q21. Can I export data from the Copilot Dashboard?

Yes, in preview, when eligible. The exporter needs the documented 50-licence threshold and global / “Your company” access; group-only access is insufficient, and the feature is unavailable in GCC. The fixed, non-customizable CSV contains **anonymized user-level rows** by default (personal identifiers are replaced with anonymised IDs); when an administrator has enabled **identifiable export** for a user (see Identification; private preview for this export), that user’s export includes identifiable fields. Rows hold weekly data for up to six months or daily data for 28 days. Dashboard filters do not customize it, and **Copilot Assisted Hours is not included**. Store it as sensitive analytics data because repeated rows or organizational-data joins can increase re-identification risk. Source: Export Copilot metrics from the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard (Last updated 15 July 2026).

Q22. Can we use Organizational Messages to boost Copilot adoption?

Yes. Organizational Messages in the Microsoft 365 admin center can send Copilot adoption nudges by email or on Windows and Teams surfaces. Email messages and usage-based targeting are generally available per the 2 June 2026 entry in the Microsoft 365 Copilot release notes. **Usage-based targeting** offers two predefined segments — Inactive Copilot users (no Copilot use in the prior 28 days) and Inactive Copilot users in Teams (prior 30 days) — and Microsoft lists it for Windows Spotlight, Taskbar, Notification Center and Teams notifications, not for email; Microsoft’s article is inconsistent about Teams (a note says Teams supports Microsoft Entra groups only), so confirm in the tenant. Configure in Microsoft 365 admin center → Organizational messages. See the Admin Setup Guide for configuration steps.

Q23. Does Microsoft Purview DLP affect Copilot usage metrics?

Potentially, but the counting behavior is not verifiable from current Microsoft Learn. DLP can block prompt processing or web grounding depending on the configured control, but the reviewed DLP and Copilot Analytics articles do not state whether a blocked attempt is counted as a Copilot action. Do not use DLP as the explanation for an adoption gap without a tenant test or Microsoft Support confirmation.

Q24. Which Microsoft 365 environments support these capabilities?

Availability is feature-specific. Worldwide has the broadest coverage. Availability varies by feature in GCC Moderate (GCC-M) and GCC High (GCC-H): no Agent Dashboard, Copilot metric export, Consumption Dashboard or Readiness page; of the Copilot Power BI templates, only Copilot business impact. API-based and Azure organizational-data imports are also not available in either. DoD and other national or regional clouds are not covered by that matrix and must be checked feature by feature; plan availability does not imply parity. Use

Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (Last updated 30 September 2026), then verify Message Center and the tenant UI.

Q25. Why might Assisted Hours or Value be lower than expected?

Optional diagnostic data affects Assisted Hours, emails sent using Copilot, Teams meetings and meeting hours summarized or recapped, and Teams chats summarized. Required diagnostic data provides only a subset. Confirm diagnostic coverage before comparing groups or periods. Assisted Hours and Value are modeled estimates, not realized savings or proof that Copilot caused a business outcome; use documented assumptions, a stable baseline, and independently governed outcome data. Source: Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 29 September 2026).

Q26. Where is Copilot Cowork usage reported, and how should I read Cowork assisted hours?

Microsoft documents two surfaces: the Microsoft 365 admin center Copilot Cowork usage dashboard (Overview, Usage, Value and Settings tabs; the Value tab is part of the Frontier preview program) and the Cowork page of the Insights Consumption Dashboard. Cowork assisted hours are “a directional estimate”, not “a direct measurement of time saved”. Tasks and billed sessions differ: multiple tasks, particularly scheduled ones, can map to one billed session. The dashboards are operational views, not invoices: reconcile charges against the monthly billing record. See Cowork Dashboard Operations for how to read and operate these dashboards. Sources: Copilot Cowork usage; How to use the Consumption Dashboard in Insights.

Q27. How do I reach the Agent 365 Dashboard view?

The Agent Dashboard has two views. Select **All agents** at the top right to open the Agent 365 Dashboard (adoption and **sessions** for all supported agents used across Microsoft 365 apps); clear it to return to the Copilot Agent Dashboard. The Agent 365 view needs Agent 365 licensing in addition to 50 Copilot licences and agent activity; if the control is absent, the tenant does not have it. Its history starts from the date the organisation accepted the Agent 365 terms of use. Source: Connect to the Agent Dashboard.

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